

PRODUCT & UX STRATEGY

User Login vs. Open Browsing Strategy

The Industry-Standard "Browse Freely • Authenticate to Act" Blueprint (Airbnb & Meetup Model)

🌐 Part 1: What ANYONE Can Do (Open Roaming)

Zero Barrier Exploration: Visitors should NEVER be forced to log in just to view the website.

- **Browse the entire home feed:** Explore Venice Beach homestays, London Eye buddy meetups, Bandra parties, Tokyo food crawls.
- **Search & Filter:** Search by city (California, Mumbai, London) and filter by category or price.
- **View full listing pages:** Inspect photos, amenities, host ratings, trust badges, and the \$1 / ₹79 fee breakdown.
- **Why this is critical:** Social sharing! When users share links on Instagram, Reddit, or WhatsApp, friends can view immediately without bouncing.

🔒 Part 2: When Login is REQUIRED (The Conversion Gate)

Security & Accountability Gate: The login modal appears only when high-intent actions take place.

- **"Request to Book / Join":** Requires an account so identity is verified and the booking is saved to their profile.
- **"Inquire via Protected Chat":** Requires a verified sender so anti-bypass contact masking and message history are tied to a real person.
- **"Host a Stay / Plan":** Requires a host account so listings, payouts, and reviews are tracked.
- **"Submit KYC / ID":** Ties Aadhaar, Passport, or DL securely to the user.

👤 Should Hosts and Participants Have Separate Logins?

NO — Modern platforms use ONE UNIFIED ACCOUNT for both.

Platforms like Airbnb, Uber, and Meetup do not have a "Host Login" and "Traveler Login". A host in California might travel to London next month and want to join a meetup! Having separate logins forces users to manage two passwords. Instead, one single account lets them switch between **Traveler Mode** and **Host Mode** with 1 click (just like our top navbar).

⚡ The Frictionless 3-Second Sign-Up Experience

- 1 **Visitor browses freely:** They find the London Eye meetup or Venice Beach homestay and click *"Request to Book"*.
- 2 **Gentle 1-Click Popup appears:** *"Sign in to complete your booking"* with two instant options:
 - **Google 1-Tap** (Fastest worldwide)
 - **Phone OTP / Email Magic Link** (Zero passwords to remember)
- 3 **Instantly logged in:** Without losing their place, their booking request is submitted and saved to their new profile in your Supabase database!